DIGITAL LITERACY

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Branch: B.Tech
Year: 2026
Course code: CSE0001
Date: 28 March

Introduction

This project focuses on developing digital literacy and understanding responsible online behaviour in an academic and professional context. It consists of multiple tasks designed to explore different aspects of digital skills, including content creation, online presence, communication, and cybersecurity awareness.

The project began with designing a digital literacy poster using Canva, followed by creating professional profiles on platforms such as LinkedIn, GitHub, and Stack Overflow. It also included practical activities like solving coding challenges, building a digital quiz using Google Forms, and understanding email etiquette through structured writing tasks.

In addition, the project explores the concept of cybercrime, specifically identity theft, and highlights preventive measures through a safety checklist tailored for students. Overall, this project simulates real-world scenarios where digital tools and responsible communication play an essential role. It aims to enhance both technical and practical skills required for effective participation in the digital world.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I created my digital literacy poster using Canva, an online design tool that offers a variety of templates, fonts, and visual elements. The poster focuses on explaining what digital literacy is, highlighting it as the ability to use digital tools effectively, safely, and responsibly. It also includes examples of useful digital tools for students, such as online collaboration platforms (LinkedIn), and research tools or online Q&A platforms (Stack Overflow). Additionally, I emphasized the importance of maintaining a professional online presence, including building a positive and responsible digital footprint.

While designing the poster, I found it interesting how visual elements like icons, colours, and layout can make information more engaging and easier to understand. At the same time, one challenge I faced was organising the content clearly without overcrowding the design. Balancing text and visuals required careful planning to ensure the poster remained both informative and visually appealing. Overall, this activity helped me better understand the importance of digital literacy in everyday academic and professional contexts.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I chose LinkedIn, Stack Overflow, and GitHub as the platforms to build my professional and technical presence. LinkedIn is mainly used for networking, creating a professional profile, and connecting with peers, mentors, and potential employers. Stack Overflow is a question-and-answer platform where programmers ask and solve technical problems, making it useful for learning and improving problem-solving skills. GitHub is a platform for hosting and managing code, allowing users to showcase projects and collaborate with others.

Over the next four years, I plan to use LinkedIn to build a strong professional network and keep track of opportunities such as internships and jobs. I will use Stack Overflow to learn from existing solutions, ask questions when needed, and gradually contribute by answering others' queries. On GitHub, I aim to regularly upload my projects, improve my coding skills, and maintain a portfolio that reflects my progress and experience. Together, these platforms will help me grow both technically and professionally.

Task 3: Exploring coding & collaboration platforms

For this task, I used HackerRank and Google Forms as my primary platforms. On HackerRank, I practised basic coding problems in Python and was able to earn a 2-star badge, which reflects my beginner-level proficiency. The platform helped me understand problem-solving approaches, improve logical thinking, and apply programming concepts in a practical way. It also gave me exposure to structured coding challenges, which are useful for building consistency in learning.

In addition, I used Google Forms to create a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz. This involved designing questions, selecting appropriate formats such as multiple choice and short answers, and linking the responses to a Google Sheet for data collection. This activity helped me understand how digital tools can be used to gather and organise information efficiently.

Overall, these platforms will support my academic growth by improving both my technical and organisational skills. HackerRank will help me strengthen my coding abilities over time, while Google Forms will be useful for conducting surveys, collecting data, and managing information for academic projects.

Task 4: Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

One situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when a student sends an email to a professor without a clear subject, proper greeting, or respectful tone. For example, writing a vague message like “Send me the notes” without context can come across as rude or confusing. This may lead to misunderstandings, delayed responses, or even a negative impression.

Similarly, on social media, posting unclear or impulsive messages can create conflicts or spread misinformation. Poor communication often results from a lack of clarity, tone awareness, or consideration of the audience.

These issues could be avoided by using proper structure in emails, including a clear subject line, polite language, and complete information. In social media use, thinking before posting and maintaining respectful communication can prevent unnecessary problems. Effective digital communication is essential for maintaining professionalism and avoiding misunderstandings.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

While researching identity theft and online safety, what surprised me most was how simple many cybercrimes are to execute. Basic tactics like phishing emails or fake links can be enough to trick users into revealing sensitive information. I had assumed such crimes required advanced technical skills, but in reality, they often rely more on human error and lack of awareness.

This made me realise how easily anyone, including students, can become a target if they are not careful. One habit I plan to change is being more cautious while interacting with links, messages, and online requests, especially those related to financial transactions. I will also make sure to use stronger passwords and enable additional security measures like two-factor authentication.

Overall, this topic has made me more aware of the importance of staying alert and practising safe online behaviour in daily digital activities.

Conclusion

This project provided a comprehensive understanding of digital literacy and its importance in both academic and professional environments. Through various tasks, I was able to explore practical applications of digital tools such as Canva, LinkedIn, GitHub, Stack Overflow, and Google Forms. These activities helped me improve my technical skills, communication abilities, and awareness of maintaining a professional online presence.

Additionally, learning about identity theft and online safety highlighted the risks associated with digital platforms and the importance of responsible behaviour. Creating checklists and analysing scenarios helped reinforce good digital habits and critical thinking. Overall, the project enhanced my confidence in using digital tools effectively and responsibly, and prepared me for future academic and career-related opportunities in a digital world.

References

- Canva
- LinkedIn
- GitHub
- Stack Overflow
- HackerRank
- Google Forms
- Google Sheets
- National Cyber Crime Portal